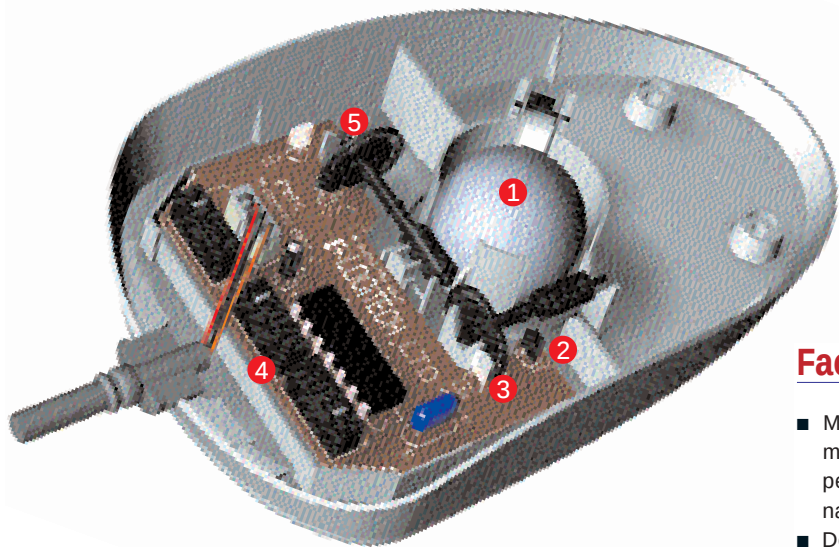




Buying Tips

- ✓ **TYPE OF MECHANISM:** Optical mice are better than the old-fashioned, rubber ball ones. They are accurate and don't require cleaning.
- ✓ **TYPE OF WIRELESS:** Unlike infrared, RF wireless connectivity doesn't require the mouse to be within line-of-sight. This makes an RF wireless mouse the obvious preference.
- ✓ **ADDON CONNECTOR:** Ensure that the manufacturer provides an USB-to-PS/2 converter, in case you have to use the device on the PS/2 port.
- ✓ **TYPE OF SCROLLING:** Some mice support only vertical scrolling, while some support horizontal scrolling as well. A mouse that offers both provides greater ease while browsing through Web pages or documents that are unusually large.
- ✓ **CABLE LENGTH:** Check if the cable is long enough to reach your cabinet.
- ✓ **NUMBER OF BUTTONS:** Opt for a three- button mouse rather than a two- button mouse. The middle button can be customised. Some mice provide you more than three customisable buttons, which come in useful while browsing, gaming, etc.
- ✓ **SYMMETRY:** Some mice are perfectly symmetrical, and hence can be used either by a left-handed or a right-handed person.
- ✓ **INTERFACE:** A device having a PS/2 interface should be preferred over a serial mouse or a USB-based mouse.

- ① **Roller:** The roller is a round rubber ball that converts the rolling of the mouse into pointer movement along the X and Y axes. The movement of the wheels breaks the continuous signal into pulses which are then converted into a digital signal, resulting in movement of mouse pointer.
- ② **X and Y Sensors:** The sensors sense the breakage in the continuous signal and convert that into a digital pulse.
- ③ **X and Y Lasers:** These lasers send a straight signal towards the sensors.
- ④ **Buttons:** Buttons are used to perform various actions such as single-clicking, double-clicking, etc.
- ⑤ **X and Y Wheels:** These wheels are slotted equally such that as the wheel moves, it allows or stops passage of signal from the lasers to the sensors

Quick Find	
YOU NEED	A cheap yet comfortable mouse
Basic Use	
LOOK FOR	A scroll mouse with a PS/2 interface
YOU NEED	Extreme precision and supreme comfort
Inter Use	
LOOK FOR	Optical scroll mouse, extra programmable buttons, PS/2, USB

Facts

- Mouse technology has survived so long mostly because it harmonises almost perfectly with human hand-eye coordination.
- Douglas Engelbart invented the 'X-Y Position Indicator for a Display System' in the 1960s, and owns the patent for it. Today, we call it the mouse.
- The first computer mouse was built of carved wood, and had one small red button that was used to select items on a computer monitor, etc. There was no room inside the casing for a second button because the electronics used in the mouse were so large.
- The first mice used two perpendicular wheels that stuck out of the bottom. Later the mouse was given a ball, which was next to a shaft. The mouse ball technology became nearly universal. The technology is still the most widely used, though other technologies have been developed.



The Future

The mouse may transition to a 'mouse glove'—a wearable device fashioned in the form of a glove. This will indeed revolutionise the way one uses PCs. It's being developed for people suffering from RSI, and will also be marketed as a gaming tool.